

Sales and Business Development English Dialogue Lab

Realistic field-specific dialogues, role-play variations, and observer checklists

Audience: account executives, business-development representatives, sales managers, partnership teams, solutions consultants, channel managers, and revenue leaders

Focus: A sales and business development English curriculum for discovery, qualification, objection handling, pricing, procurement, enterprise buying committees, negotiation, partnership language, and CRM discipline.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

Dialogue Practice Method

Read each exchange once for meaning, once for tone, and once for decision structure. Then complete the missing language by selecting one of four options and check the rationale at the end.

1. Discovery and Qualification

Setting

A prospect asks for a demo before explaining their problem.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Show the full demo immediately.
Prospect	Pain, priority, authority, timeline, and business impact need qualification.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm discovery, qualification, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short discovery call plan. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: discovery, qualification.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	mitigation
B	discovery call plan
C	timeline
D	assumption

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

2. Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Setting

A prospect likes the product but cannot name a use case.

Speaker	Line
Solutions consultant	Push for next steps anyway.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Use case, stakeholder value, success metric, and urgency need definition.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm value proposition, use case, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Solutions consultant	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short value mapping note. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: value proposition, use case.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	competitive objection response
B	discount approval request
C	value mapping note
D	discovery call plan

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

3. Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Setting

A prospect says a competitor is cheaper.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	Discount immediately.
Prospect	Total value, risk, scope, implementation, and commercial terms need comparison.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm objection, competitor, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short competitive objection response. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: objection, competitor.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	competitive objection response
B	pipeline inspection notes
C	evidence
D	risk

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

4. Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Setting

Procurement demands a last-minute discount.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Approve it to close the quarter.
Revenue operations	Pricing policy, margin, term length, volume, and approval path must be reviewed.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm discount, procurement, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short discount approval request. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: discount, procurement.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	discovery call plan
B	value mapping note
C	discount approval request
D	disclosure

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

5. Enterprise Buying Committees

Setting

A champion says the deal is done but legal has not reviewed it.

Speaker	Line
Sales director	Forecast the deal as committed.
Account executive	Decision criteria, legal, security, finance, and executive sponsor status matter.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm champion, economic buyer, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales director	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short deal-risk update. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: champion, economic buyer.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	deal-risk update
B	competitive objection response
C	discount approval request
D	redline escalation

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

6. Negotiation and Contract Redlines

Setting

A customer requests unlimited liability in the contract.

Speaker	Line
Account executive	Agree because it is a strategic deal.
Legal counsel	Risk allocation, legal approval, insurance, and business value need decision.

Speaker	Line
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm redline, liability, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Account executive	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short redline escalation. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: redline, liability.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	deal-risk update
B	partner term outline
C	redline escalation
D	discount approval request

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

7. Partnerships and Channel Development

Setting

A potential partner wants exclusivity before proving pipeline.

Speaker	Line
Business-development lead	Grant exclusivity to secure the relationship.
Partner	Territory, targets, enablement, economics, and performance gates need clarity.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm channel partner, exclusivity, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Business-development lead	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short partner term outline. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: channel partner, exclusivity.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	scope
B	timeline
C	partner term outline
D	owner

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

8. CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

Setting

A rep keeps stale opportunities in late stages.

Speaker	Line
Sales manager	Leave them because the pipeline looks stronger.
Account executive	Next step, close date, buyer evidence, and risk should drive forecast accuracy.
ESL learner	I understand the goal, but we need to separate urgency from control. For this decision, I need to confirm CRM, pipeline, the owner, and the evidence standard before we commit.
Sales manager	What would let us move forward without slowing everything down?
ESL learner	Let's document the assumption, define the risk trigger, and create a short pipeline inspection notes. Then we can decide whether to proceed, escalate, or revise the plan.

Language notes

- The learner names the field-specific control point instead of giving a vague no: CRM, pipeline.
- The response preserves the business goal while adding evidence, owner, and next-step discipline.

Guided dialogue completion

Let's document the risk and prepare a _____ with facts, caveats, owner, and next step.

Choose the missing language

Option	Phrase
A	pipeline inspection notes
B	competitive objection response
C	discount approval request
D	deal-risk update

Observer checklist

- Did the learner name the decision and the risk?
- Did the learner use at least two industry terms accurately?
- Did the learner give a concrete next step without overpromising?

Answer Key and Rationale

Check each answer after completing the dialogue. The rationale shows why the correct phrase is the strongest fit for the real workplace situation.

Discovery and Qualification

Correct answer	Why it fits
B. discovery call plan	A discovery call plan is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. value mapping note	A value mapping note is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. competitive objection response	A competitive objection response is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. discount approval request	A discount approval request is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Enterprise Buying Committees

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. deal-risk update	A deal-risk update is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Negotiation and Contract Redlines

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. redline escalation	A redline escalation is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

Partnerships and Channel Development

Correct answer	Why it fits
C. partner term outline	A partner term outline is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.

CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

Correct answer	Why it fits
A. pipeline inspection notes	A pipeline inspection notes is the bounded workplace output that captures the evidence, owner, and next action for this situation.